

FLORENCE'S SUNDAY POT ROAST

Rush family recipe - Fritz's handwritten copy typed up

Prep 20 min | Cook 3 hr 30 min | Serves 6 | Dutch oven required

INGREDIENTS

For the roast:

- 3 to 4 lb chuck roast, well-marbled (Costco grass-fed works)
- 2 tbsp neutral oil (grapeseed or canola)
- Kosher salt (Diamond Crystal), fresh cracked black pepper
- 2 tbsp all-purpose flour

For the braise:

- 1 large yellow onion, rough chopped
- 4 carrots, cut into 2-inch pieces
- 4 celery stalks, cut into 2-inch pieces
- 6 cloves garlic, smashed
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 cup dry red wine (whatever we have open, nothing fancy)
- 3 cups beef broth (Trader Joe's or homemade if a stock day)
- 2 bay leaves
- 4 sprigs fresh thyme (from the patio pot, or dried in a pinch)
- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary (from the patio pot)
- 1 lb small Yukon Gold or fingerling potatoes, halved
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, quartered (Fritz's addition, not in Florence's original)

METHOD

1. Pat the roast dry. Season aggressively on all sides with kosher salt and black pepper. Dust with flour, tap off excess. Let sit at room temperature 30 minutes while the aromatics get chopped.
2. Heat oil in the Dutch oven over medium-high heat until shimmering. Sear the roast on all sides, 3 to 4 minutes per side, until deeply browned. Do not rush this step. The fond in the bottom of the pot is where the flavor lives. Transfer the roast to a plate.
3. Reduce heat to medium. Add the onion, carrots, and celery. Cook 6 to 8 minutes until softened and starting to color. Add the garlic and tomato paste. Cook another 2 minutes, stirring, until the paste darkens a shade.
4. Pour in the red wine to deglaze. Scrape the fond off the bottom of the pot with a wooden spoon. Let the wine reduce by half, about 3 minutes.
5. Add the beef broth, bay leaves, thyme, and rosemary. Return the roast to the pot along with any accumulated juices. The liquid should come about two-thirds up the side of the roast. If short, add water.
6. Cover the pot. Transfer to a 325-degree oven. Cook 2 hours 30 minutes.
7. Add the potatoes and mushrooms to the pot, submerging them in the braising

liquid. Return to the oven, covered, for 1 more hour, or until the roast pulls apart with a fork and the potatoes are tender.

8. Transfer the roast and vegetables to a serving platter. Skim fat off the top of the braising liquid. Reduce the liquid on the stovetop over medium-high heat until it coats the back of a spoon, 5 to 10 minutes. Taste for salt.

9. Slice or pull the roast. Spoon the sauce over. Serve with crusty bread.

FRITZ'S NOTES

Florence made this every Sunday for as long as I can remember. Her original called for canned tomatoes instead of tomato paste and no mushrooms. My tweaks are the paste (deeper color) and the mushrooms (more umami). Wine got added when Diane came along.

I make this most Sundays that are not Friday-pizza-night blowouts. Carter eats around the mushrooms. Ava demolishes the carrots. Diane's contribution is the crusty bread from Little Tart Bakeshop when we plan ahead.

Cooking timing usually: start the sear at 12:30 PM after the Sunday call to my mother wraps and after church. In the oven by 1:00 PM. Vegetables in at 3:30 PM. Eating around 4:45 PM which lands us at family bedtime with enough leftovers for Monday clinic lunch.

Doubling up: for the neighborhood dinners a 6 lb roast in a bigger vessel scales

cleanly. Timing goes to 3 hr 45 min braise plus 1 hr with vegetables.

REMEMBER

Florence taught me this. She taught herself from her own mother's Denver kitchen. When I make it here, she is in the pot even when she is in Denver on the other end of the Sunday call. That's the point.